

MOTHERS OF

NOT SO MUCH AS NECESSITY, BUT THE BRAVE AND UNIMAGINABLE EFFORTS OF PIONEERING WOMEN HAVE LED TO **SOME OF THE GREATEST TECHNOLOGICAL BREAKTHROUGHS AND INVENTIONS THAT MANKIND HAS EVER WITNESSED**

BY JAYESH SHINDE

We live in a world surrounded by technology. A marvel of human ingenuity that has strived to make our life more comfortable than ever before – whether it's by the way we travel, work, access information or communicate. Technology has refined, rejigged and revolutionised the way we live our life. And we just can't imagine a life where we'd be comfortable living in a world devoid of our digital distractions and dependencies.

Imagine this scenario: You're living in a well-to-do household, where not only are your basic needs taken care of, but you also have money to spend on digital accompaniments to improve your standard of living – you know, things like a refrigerator, washing machine, microwave oven, electric kettle and other essentials. Then there are things such as your car, gaming console, television, laptop and other digital paraphernalia that surrounds us, adding another level of satisfaction and fulfillment altogether. Where would we be without our digital dimensions?

Technology has seeped into every facet of our life. When you come to this realisation, this revelation that technology is far more ubiquitous than you'd care to stop and think about, the next

question that begs to be answered is, well, who invented some of the technological marvels that we take for granted in the 21st century? Scientists, engineers, pioneers and mavericks they all were, but who were they?

In response to that question, it wouldn't be surprising to get answers such as Thomas Edison, Nikola Tesla, Alexander Graham Bell, Benjamin Franklin, Charles Babbage or even modern mavericks like Steve Jobs, Bill Gates, Larry Ellison and Elon Musk. And you won't be wrong to jump to those conclusions either. But, therein lies the tragedy of the situation.

Nine out of ten times it's always the men of tech breakthroughs and innovations who are remembered, never the women – despite their equally noble and path-breaking technological breakthroughs – which are seldom remembered in the first breath. That's a sad state of affairs right there. It would be a complete fallacy to assume that women innovators, technologists and pioneers didn't take as much effort to further the pace of technological breakthroughs and innovations as their male counterparts. Women are no less competent than men when it comes to holding their own in the arena of invention and ingenuity. We kid you not.

You want proof? Here it comes in all its shining glory!